Input: Are these reviews positive or negative?

Claude AI output: Mixed, leaning slightly negative. Here's my rough tally of the 110 reviews:

- **Negative:** about 40 (36%)
- **Positive:** about 37 (34%)
- **Mixed:** about 17 (15%)
- **Neutral or indifferent** ("it's fine," "it's a kettle"): about 12 (11%)
- **Questions, not reviews:** 4 (R012, R067, R087, R101)

About 10 of the negatives are sarcastic and read as positive at a glance, such as R022 ("Ten stars" for a waterproof pack that soaked a sleeping bag), R066, R068, R085, and R108. A basic sentiment tool would likely miscount these.

Sentiment also varies a lot by product:

- **Cozy Knit Throw Blanket:** leans positive. People like the softness and look, with complaints about size, snagging, shedding, and shrinking.
- **Hearth Electric Kettle:** polarized. Many love the speed and design, but several reviews report safety problems (leaks, a hot handle) or early failures.
- **Trailmark Hiking Backpack:** split. Reviewers praise durability and value, but others report broken zippers and buckles, and "waterproof" and size claims not holding up.
- **Breeze Wireless Earbuds:** mixed. Sound and battery get praise, but there are connectivity, comfort, and fit complaints.
- **Lumen Smart Bulbs:** the most negative. The bulbs themselves are liked, but the app, Wi-Fi drops, and reliability draw most of the criticism.

Some negative reviews are about shipping or delivery rather than the product (R062, R093), and a few positive ones praise customer service rather than the item (R014, R084). If you're judging product quality specifically, those should probably be separated out.

I can break this down per product with counts, or flag the sarcastic reviews so you can see which ones they are.

Input: You are a research student tasked with checking this list of item reviews, making sure it makes sense. Are two labels (positive/negative) enough, or do some reviews need another category?

Claude AI output: No, two labels aren't enough. After going through all 110 reviews, a binary scheme forces a lot of reviews into a label that misrepresents them. Here's what breaks down.

1. Neutral / lukewarm (clearly needed)

These reviews express neither satisfaction nor dissatisfaction:

R037 “They’re lightbulbs. They light up.”

R104 “It boils water. It’s a kettle.”

R043 “It’s fine. Does the job, nothing special.”

R038 “they r ok i guess. not bad not great”

R042 “Ok for the price”

R092 “It’s a blanket. Keeps me warm.”

R016 “He says it’s ‘fine.’”

R029 “Fine for podcasts. Wouldn’t use them for music.”

2. Mixed (the biggest gap)

Many reviews contain a real positive and a real negative of comparable weight. Forcing either label loses information:

R060 Great battery, terrible mic

R055 Love the presets, beep is too loud

R071 Beautiful and cozy, but shrank in the wash

R075 Very soft, but too small

R097 Love the sound, hate the touch controls

R059 Waterproof, but hip belt needs padding

R041 Too many pockets, but very well made

R009 Great bulbs, terrible app

R008 Bright and colorful, but disconnects

R063 Boils fast, but small capacity

R002 Decent isolation, misleading description, still good for the gym

R099 Pretty but impractical

3. Off-topic / no opinion about the product

Some reviews say nothing about product quality, so any sentiment label would be invented:

Questions: R012 (Google Home?), R067 (16-inch laptop?), R087 (dimensions?), R101 (PS5?)

No evaluation yet: R057 (haven't tried it), R089 ("looks nice," just received), R094 (gift, unopened)

Pure logistics: R026 (arrived a day early), R062 (shipping took 3 weeks), R093 (driver left it in the rain), R019 (wrong size sent)

4. Sarcasm (a labeling hazard, not a new category)

Sarcastic reviews are positive on the surface and negative in meaning, so they'll be mislabeled by keyword-based methods and by careless annotators: R022, R024, R030, R066, R068, R078, R080, R085, R098, R108. Also R030 ("Fantastic. Just fantastic. Mine lasted a full week"). Annotation guidelines should say to label by intended meaning.

5. Product vs. service/fulfillment split

Several reviews separate product quality from the seller's handling, and the two point in opposite directions:

R014: dented on arrival, great support, kettle fine

R056: crushed box, earbuds fine

R013: failed after 6 weeks, replacement works

R084: pairing problem, support fixed it

R003: product failed, support ignored them

A single label can't say whether the product or the company is being praised or blamed. Consider an aspect-level scheme (product / shipping / support) instead of, or alongside, overall sentiment.

Other issues worth flagging

Sentiment vs. severity: R048 (leaks near an outlet) and R049 (burned hand) are safety issues, not just complaints. They may deserve a separate flag.

Internal contradictions: R020 and R036 (wrong color, "still a good bag" / "kept it anyway") are negative on one aspect and positive overall.

Very short or low-information reviews: R042, R047, R069, R106 carry little signal, though they're at least classifiable.

Duplicated sentiment in lists: R010 and R035 are clearly positive, but R035 is positive by repeat purchase rather than stated opinion, which is fine but worth noting.

Recommendation

A workable scheme would be positive / negative / mixed / neutral, plus an N/A (no opinion) label for questions and unevaluated or logistics-only reviews. If you can afford more annotation effort, add aspect tags (product, shipping, support, safety).

Rough estimate from my read: about 10 to 15% of reviews are mixed, roughly 8% neutral, and around 12 to 15% have no product opinion at all, so a binary scheme would misrepresent nearly a third of this dataset.

Analysis: Using the define-the-category technique caused the AI to recommend adding more columns because the reviews vary too widely to be binary. This also led to a deeper analysis, though I'm not sure whether giving it a role affected the output much. For some reviews I thought were positive or negative, or had realistic downsides/upsides, the AI labeled them lukewarm or mixed. The AI also labeled a review I thought was positive as no opinion, and reviews labeled as "sarcasm" are straight-up negative.

Input: Explain how most of the reviewers feel about this product, and make the explanation brief. For example, if I say "I'm so glad I got a broken mattress" or "I love that my headphones sound very staticy," that's a negative review.

Claude AI output: Your file covers five products, so here's a quick read on each. I counted sarcastic reviews like "Love that the 'waterproof' pack turned my sleeping bag into a sponge" as negative.

Trailmark Hiking Backpack: Leans positive, about 10 positive to 8 negative. People praise its durability and value, while the complaints are about broken zippers and buckles, stitching, and size.
Cozy Knit Throw Blanket: Roughly split, slightly positive. Reviewers like how soft and cozy it looks, but others cite shedding, snagging, unraveling, and shrinking.
Hearth Electric Kettle: Split. It boils fast and looks good, but some units broke or leaked, and a few reviewers flagged safety problems (a hot handle, a leak near an outlet).
Breeze Wireless Earbuds: Split. Fans like the sound, comfort, and battery, while critics report fit, connectivity, and durability problems.
Lumen Smart Bulbs: Leans negative. The colors and features are liked, but app crashes, Wi-Fi drops, dead bulbs, and early failures are common complaints.

Overall, none of the five is a clear hit. Opinion is mixed everywhere, and the Lumen bulbs have the weakest sentiment. If you meant one specific product, tell me which and I'll go into more detail.

Analysis: The constraint I used challenged the AI to write brief explanations of how each product was reviewed, and my few-shot prompting caused the AI to interpret sarcasm as negative.

Input: Could you turn this into a table and add any columns you think are needed?

Claude AI output:
I added four columns: **Sentiment**, **Theme**, **Flag** and **Sarcasm**. A few reviews are sarcastic (e.g. R022, R030, R066), so I scored those by their intended meaning, not their literal wording. I used the Flag column to separate things that aren't really about product quality, like questions and shipping problems.

ID	Product	Review	Sentiment	Theme	Flag	Sarcasm
R001	Trailmark Hiking Backpack	Smells like chemicals out of the box. Took a week to air out.	Negative	Odor / materials		No
R002	Breeze Wireless Earbuds	Noise isolation is decent, but it's not true noise cancelling like the description implies. Still good for the gym.	Mixed	Sound quality	Listing mismatch	No
R003	Breeze Wireless Earbuds	Left earbud stopped charging after two weeks. Contacted support and never heard	Negative	Defect / customer service		No

		back.				
R004	Trailmark Hiking Backpack	Straps dig into my shoulders after an hour. Returning.	Negative	Comfort	Return	No
R005	Cozy Knit Throw Blanket	Not warm enough for winter. Fine as a decorative throw.	Mixed	Warmth		No
R006	Breeze Wireless Earbuds	Perfect for my commute. Clear calls, solid battery.	Positive	Call quality / battery		No
R007	Trailmark Hiking Backpack	decent bag for the money, not for serious backpackin g tho	Mixed	Value / fit for purpose		No
R008	Lumen Smart Bulbs (4-Pack)	Bright and colorful, but they disconnect from Wi-Fi every few days.	Mixed	Connectivit y		No
R009	Lumen Smart Bulbs (4-Pack)	Great bulbs, terrible app. If you can get past setup you'll love them.	Mixed	App / setup		No
R010	Hearth Electric Kettle	Second one I've bought, gave the	Positive	Durability	Repeat purchase	No

		first to my mom. Still going strong after a year.				
R011	Cozy Knit Throw Blanket	Arrived with a stain on it.	Negative	Condition on arrival	Fulfillment	No
R012	Lumen Smart Bulbs (4-Pack)	Do these work with Google Home or only Alexa?	Neutral	Compatibility	Question	No
R013	Hearth Electric Kettle	Stopped turning on after 6 weeks. Customer service sent a replacement, which works so far.	Mixed	Durability / customer service		No
R014	Hearth Electric Kettle	Mine arrived dented and customer service shipped a new one the next day. The kettle itself is fine.	Positive	Customer service	Shipping damage	No
R015	Trailmark Hiking Backpack	Way too small for anything over a day trip despite what the listing says.	Negative	Size / capacity	Listing mismatch	No

R016	Trailmark Hiking Backpack	Ordered for my husband. He says it’s “fine.”	Neutral	General	Secondhand opinion	No
R017	Trailmark Hiking Backpack	Absolutely bombproof. Dragged it through brush, rocks, and rivers with zero damage.	Positive	Durability		No
R018	Lumen Smart Bulbs (4-Pack)	Colors look washed out compared to other brands I’ve used.	Negative	Color quality		No
R019	Trailmark Hiking Backpack	Seller sent the wrong size.	Negative	Wrong item	Fulfillment	No
R020	Trailmark Hiking Backpack	Color is different from the photos. More brown than green. Still a good bag.	Mixed	Color accuracy	Listing mismatch	No
R021	Trailmark Hiking Backpack	Great value. Feels much more expensive than it was.	Positive	Value		No
R022	Trailmark Hiking Backpack	Love that the “waterproof” pack	Negative	Waterproofing	Listing mismatch	Yes

		turned my sleeping bag into a sponge. Ten stars.				
R023	Lumen Smart Bulbs (4-Pack)	Sunrise alarm feature has made my mornings so much easier.	Positive	Features		No
R024	Lumen Smart Bulbs (4-Pack)	wow so smart, it forgot all my settings after an update. genius.	Negative	Software / updates		Yes
R025	Lumen Smart Bulbs (4-Pack)	Buzzes when dimmed below 30%. Very annoying in a quiet room.	Negative	Dimming / noise		No
R026	Lumen Smart Bulbs (4-Pack)	Package arrived a day early.	Neutral	Shipping	Not about product	No
R027	Hearth Electric Kettle	Boils water in under 3 minutes. Sleek design looks great on my counter.	Positive	Performance / design		No
R028	Breeze Wireless Earbuds	Returned them. Constant static in	Negative	Sound / defect	Return	No

		the right ear.				
R029	Breeze Wireless Earbuds	Fine for podcasts. Wouldn't use them for music.	Mixed	Sound quality		No
R030	Hearth Electric Kettle	Fantastic. Just fantastic. Mine lasted a full week before the switch broke.	Negative	Durability / defect		Yes
R031	Lumen Smart Bulbs (4-Pack)	App crashes constantly. Half the time the bulbs won't respond.	Negative	App / connectivity		No
R032	Hearth Electric Kettle	Keep warm function only lasts 30 minutes, which is useless for me.	Negative	Features		No
R033	Breeze Wireless Earbuds	Best purchase I've made all year. My old $200 pair is collecting dust now.	Positive	Overall / value		No
R034	Lumen Smart Bulbs	Setup took two minutes	Positive	Setup / features		No

	(4-Pack)	and the colors are vibrant. Love the scheduling feature.				
R035	Lumen Smart Bulbs (4-Pack)	Bought a second 4-pack for the rest of the house. That's how much I like them.	Positive	Overall	Repeat purchase	No
R036	Cozy Knit Throw Blanket	Ordered the gray and got navy. Kept it anyway since it's nice.	Mixed	Wrong item / color	Fulfillment	No
R037	Lumen Smart Bulbs (4-Pack)	They're lightbulbs. They light up.	Neutral	General	Low information	No
R038	Breeze Wireless Earbuds	they r ok i guess. not bad not great	Neutral	General		No
R039	Hearth Electric Kettle	Bought this for my office. Coworkers keep asking where I got it.	Positive	Design / overall		No
R040	Cozy Knit Throw Blanket	My toddler drags it everywhere and it still looks new. Impressive.	Positive	Durability		No

R041	Trailmark Hiking Backpack	Too many pockets honestly. I can never find anything. But very well made.	Mixed	Design / build quality		No
R042	Cozy Knit Throw Blanket	Ok for the price	Neutral	Value		No
R043	Hearth Electric Kettle	It's fine. Does the job, nothing special.	Neutral	General		No
R044	Trailmark Hiking Backpack	Comfortable, durable, and the side pockets actually fit a water bottle. Rare!	Positive	Comfort / design		No
R045	Cozy Knit Throw Blanket	Perfect weight for summer evenings on the porch.	Positive	Weight / warmth		No
R046	Cozy Knit Throw Blanket	So soft and warm. My cat has claimed it as hers.	Positive	Softness / warmth		No
R047	Trailmark Hiking Backpack	10/10 would recommend to anyone getting into hiking.	Positive	Overall		No
R048	Hearth	Leaks from	Negative	Safety /	Safety	No

	Electric Kettle	the bottom. Dangerous near an electrical outlet.		defect		
R049	Hearth Electric Kettle	The handle gets dangerously hot. Burned my hand the first day.	Negative	Safety / design	Safety	No
R050	Hearth Electric Kettle	I use it for pour-over coffee and the gooseneck spout gives great control.	Positive	Features / design		No
R051	Hearth Electric Kettle	The cord is too short to reach anywhere useful.	Negative	Design		No
R052	Breeze Wireless Earbuds	I was skeptical but these are fantastic. Would buy again.	Positive	Overall		No
R053	Lumen Smart Bulbs (4-Pack)	One of the four bulbs was dead on arrival.	Negative	Defect (DOA)		No
R054	Breeze Wireless Earbuds	Super comfortable, I forget I'm wearing them. Pairing was	Positive	Comfort / pairing		No

		instant.				
R055	Hearth Electric Kettle	Love the temperatur e presets for tea. The beep when it finishes is way too loud though.	Mixed	Features / noise		No
R056	Breeze Wireless Earbuds	Box arrived crushed but the earbuds inside were fine. They work well.	Positive	Performan ce	Shipping damage	No
R057	Hearth Electric Kettle	Took forever to get here and the box was wet. Haven't tried it yet.	Neutral	Shipping	Not about product	No
R058	Cozy Knit Throw Blanket	Shed everywher e. My couch is covered in fuzz.	Negative	Shedding		No
R059	Trailmark Hiking Backpack	Waterproof as advertised and stayed dry in a downpour. Wish the hip belt had more padding.	Mixed	Waterproof ing / comfort		No

R060	Breeze Wireless Earbuds	Battery life is great, easily 7 hours. Mic is terrible though, everyone says I sound like I'm underwater.	Mixed	Battery / mic quality		No
R061	Trailmark Hiking Backpack	My son uses it for school and it's held up all year.	Positive	Durability		No
R062	Breeze Wireless Earbuds	Shipping took 3 weeks.	Negative	Shipping	Not about product	No
R063	Hearth Electric Kettle	Small capacity, only enough for about 3 mugs. Boils fast though.	Mixed	Capacity / speed		No
R064	Trailmark Hiking Backpack	Carried this through a 5-day trek. Comfortable straps, tons of pockets.	Positive	Comfort / design		No
R065	Trailmark Hiking Backpack	Zipper broke on the first hike.	Negative	Defect (zipper)		No
R066	Breeze Wireless Earbuds	Absolutely love how they fall out every	Negative	Fit		Yes

		time I turn my head. Great feature.				
R067	Trailmark Hiking Backpack	Is the laptop sleeve big enough for a 16-inch laptop?	Neutral	Size / compatibility	Question	No
R068	Cozy Knit Throw Blanket	Wonderful, it’s itchy AND thin. Two for one.	Negative	Material / thickness		Yes
R069	Cozy Knit Throw Blanket	love love love!!! buying another	Positive	Overall	Repeat purchase	No
R070	Lumen Smart Bulbs (4-Pack)	Warm white setting is nice and cozy. Never use the colors.	Positive	Features		No
R071	Cozy Knit Throw Blanket	Beautiful color and super cozy, but it shrank in the wash even on cold.	Mixed	Shrinkage / appearance		No
R072	Breeze Wireless Earbuds	Not as good as my AirPods but for a quarter of the price I can’t complain.	Positive	Value		No
R073	Lumen	Good	Mixed	Value		No

	Smart Bulbs (4-Pack)	enough for the price. I'd buy a better brand next time though.				
R074	Hearth Electric Kettle	Mineral buildup after one month even with filtered water. Disappointed.	Negative	Maintenance / materials		No
R075	Cozy Knit Throw Blanket	Smaller than expected. Barely covers my lap. Very soft though.	Mixed	Size / softness		No
R076	Breeze Wireless Earbuds	Worst earbuds I've ever owned. Save your money.	Negative	Overall	Low information	No
R077	Breeze Wireless Earbuds	Sound quality is amazing for the price. Bass is punchy and they stay in during runs.	Positive	Sound / fit		No
R078	Cozy Knit Throw Blanket	I'm thrilled that it smells like a warehouse	Negative	Odor		Yes

		even after three washes.				
R079	Cozy Knit Throw Blanket	Gave one to each of my daughters for Christmas. They both love them.	Positive	Overall	Gift	No
R080	Trailmark Hiking Backpack	Oh sure, I just love when the buckle snaps halfway up a mountain.	Negative	Defect (buckle)		Yes
R081	Cozy Knit Throw Blanket	Washes well, no pilling after many cycles. Great quality.	Positive	Durability		No
R082	Trailmark Hiking Backpack	Perfect size for day hikes. The hydration sleeve is a nice bonus.	Positive	Size / features		No
R083	Cozy Knit Throw Blanket	Looks way more expensive than it is. Guests always compliment it.	Positive	Appearance / value		No
R084	Lumen Smart	Had a problem	Positive	Customer service /		No

	Bulbs (4-Pack)	pairing, but support walked me through it in 10 minutes. Now everything works.		setup		
R085	Hearth Electric Kettle	Oh good, a kettle that makes my water taste like plastic. Exactly what I wanted.	Negative	Taste / materials		Yes
R086	Lumen Smart Bulbs (4-Pack)	Works perfectly with Alexa. Voice control is a game changer for my mom, who has limited mobility.	Positive	Compatibility / accessibility		No
R087	Cozy Knit Throw Blanket	What are the dimensions? The listing doesn’t say.	Neutral	Listing info (size)	Question	No
R088	Lumen Smart Bulbs (4-Pack)	Fun for parties! The music sync mode is a hit.	Positive	Features		No
R089	Trailmark Hiking Backpack	Received it today, looks nice.	Neutral	Appearance	Low information	No
R090	Hearth	Gorgeous	Positive	Design /		No

	Electric Kettle	kettle, quick boil, quiet. No complaints at all.		performance		
R091	Hearth Electric Kettle	Lid won't stay closed. Steam everywhere.	Negative	Defect (lid)		No
R092	Cozy Knit Throw Blanket	It's a blanket. Keeps me warm.	Neutral	Warmth	Low information	No
R093	Cozy Knit Throw Blanket	Delivery driver left it in the rain.	Negative	Delivery	Not about product	No
R094	Breeze Wireless Earbuds	Bought these as a gift for my brother. He hasn't opened them yet.	Neutral	None	Gift / not used	No
R095	Trailmark Hiking Backpack	The stitching is already coming apart and I've only used it twice.	Negative	Durability		No
R096	Lumen Smart Bulbs (4-Pack)	Requires an account and wants my location data just to turn on a light. No thanks.	Negative	Privacy / app		No
R097	Breeze Wireless	Love the sound,	Mixed	Sound / controls		No

	Earbuds	hate the touch controls. Every time I adjust them the music pauses.				
R098	Lumen Smart Bulbs (4-Pack)	Nothing says “smart home” like having to unplug the router to turn on my lights.	Negative	Connectivity		Yes
R099	Cozy Knit Throw Blanket	The knit pattern snags on everything. Pretty but impractical.	Mixed	Design / durability		No
R100	Lumen Smart Bulbs (4-Pack)	Stopped working entirely after a month. Waste of money.	Negative	Durability		No
R101	Breeze Wireless Earbuds	Does anyone know if these work with a PS5?	Neutral	Compatibility	Question	No
R102	Cozy Knit Throw Blanket	Best throw blanket I’ve owned. Heavy, warm, and soft.	Positive	Overall / warmth		No

R103	Breeze Wireless Earbuds	meh. sound is tinny and they hurt after an hour	Negative	Sound / comfort		No
R104	Hearth Electric Kettle	It boils water. It's a kettle.	Neutral	General	Low information	No
R105	Hearth Electric Kettle	Wish it came in more colors. Otherwise perfect.	Positive	Color options		No
R106	Hearth Electric Kettle	good kettle!!! fast and pretty	Positive	Performance / design		No
R107	Cozy Knit Throw Blanket	Unraveling after a month. Poor quality.	Negative	Durability		No
R108	Breeze Wireless Earbuds	Wow, they lasted a whole three days before disconnecting every five minutes. Truly impressive engineering.	Negative	Connectivity / durability		Yes
R109	Breeze Wireless Earbuds	Charging case feels cheap and the lid snapped off within a month.	Negative	Build quality		No

R110	Lumen Smart Bulbs (4-Pack)	Not as bright as a regular 60W bulb despite the claim.	Negative	Brightness	Listing mismatch	No

A few patterns stand out. Seven of the kettle reviews (R030, R048, R049, R074, R085, R091, plus R013's failure) point to reliability or safety problems, and R048 and R049 are worth escalating. The Lumen bulbs mostly get complaints about the app and connectivity, while the hardware itself is generally liked. The backpack's most common problem is listing accuracy: size, waterproofing and color.

I can also put this in an Excel file with filters and a summary tab by product and sentiment if you'd like.

Analysis: Using the Output format technique lets the AI use creativity to create a table with more columns that fit specific reviews.